

MADALENA BEÇA KNITWEAR

WEBSITE — VERSION 3 REVIEW

Homepage feedback and instructions for Version 4

Objective: preserve the strong editorial and fashion-sensitive concept while making the homepage clearer, more proportionate and more effective as a B2B manufacturing website.

CORE DIRECTION

Keep the visual identity. Strengthen the B2B information hierarchy. Reduce unnecessary vertical space without turning the site into an information dashboard.

1. Overall direction

The concept of the homepage should be maintained. The colour palette, editorial character, material photography and contrast between light and dark sections give MBK a more distinctive and fashion-relevant presence than a conventional manufacturing website. The next version should therefore refine the current concept rather than redesign it.

- The homepage must communicate quickly that MBK is a specialised B2B flat-knit development and manufacturing partner for fashion brands.
- The information hierarchy should be clearer: first identify the company and its value, then show product breadth, process, Studio, responsibility, knowledge and conversion.
- Reduce sections that use excessive height for limited information. We are not asking that every section fit within one viewport; we are asking for a more efficient and coherent vertical rhythm.
- On desktop, section openings should feel intentionally composed. Avoid landing on a page with the hero followed by a cut-off photograph or half of the next title. A partial next section should only be visible when it is clearly deliberate and visually balanced.
- No heading or section title should collide with or sit underneath the fixed navigation. Please solve this at component/layout level across breakpoints, rather than adjusting individual titles manually.

2. Header and navigation

1. Keep the navigation fixed during scroll, but ensure it has sufficient opacity/contrast so it remains readable over text and imagery.
2. Use the approved MBK logo/wordmark consistently, including the initial site-loading/fav icon treatment.
3. Change “Let’s Talk” to “Start a Project”. Keep this as the single primary CTA in the header, positioned at the upper-right.
4. Do not add a second “Start a Project” button inside the hero. The header CTA is already visible there. Repeating the CTA is appropriate later, at the closing conversion section after the visitor has explored the page.

Esta disposição de informações no Hero estava de acordo com o design definido inicialmente pela cliente. Não havíamos feito qualquer alteração pois não queríamos sobrepôr aquilo que já havia sido aprovado e devidamente solicitado. Procedemos à respetiva atualização.

3. Homepage — recommended Version 4 structure

Please follow the structure below in this order. The wording supplied in quotation-style blocks is the proposed final website copy unless a layout constraint requires a very minor adjustment.

01 — Hero

Quiet excellence in contemporary knitwear.

Specialised flat-knit development and manufacturing for fashion brands — in our own facilities in Portugal since 1998.

- Keep the existing macro-knit/yarn visual concept and the editorial serif/script treatment.

- Reduce or rebalance the headline only as needed to create a clear relationship between the H1, the company descriptor, navigation and supporting information. The objective is not simply to make the title smaller; it is to make the first screen more informative and harmonious.
- The supporting references “Made in Portugal” and GOTS · RWS · GRS · OCS may remain as secondary information, but they need sufficient contrast and should not compete with the company descriptor.
- Review the hero animation/fade so there is no visibly hard cut or artificial edge during movement. Provide a reduced-motion alternative for users who prefer it.

02 — MBK in one view

Remove the existing full-screen numeric statistics module (1998 / 4 / 15 / 100%) as a standalone section. Keep the “A family of makers” message, but move it into this compact company-introduction section rather than giving it a full-screen treatment. The individual statistics are valid, but the current module gives them disproportionate visual importance and resembles a common manufacturer statistic block without adding enough differentiation.

Technical development. In-house manufacturing. One accountable partner.

A family of makers: precise, attentive and closely involved in every stage of development. Made entirely in our own facilities in Portugal.

From development and programming to knitting, garment assembly, finishing and quality control, MBK keeps the core stages of flat-knit production closely connected — giving fashion brands direct access to the people developing and making their product.

Below this short introduction, use three concise proof points. These are not large statistics. They should be three small, visually equal modules (for example three columns on desktop), each with a short label and one supporting line:

CLIENT-SPECIFIC DEVELOPMENT

Technical support from yarn and structure through fit and approval.

IN-HOUSE FLAT-KNIT PRODUCTION

Core development and production in our own facilities in Penafiel, Portugal.

FAMILY-OWNED SINCE 1998

Continuity of knowledge, people and relationships across collections.

Do not replace the removed age statistic with a “5 gauges” statistic in this module. Gauges 3, 5, 7, 10 and 12 are useful technical information, but they belong in the capabilities/How We Work context rather than as a marketing number on the homepage.

03 — Product breadth

Knitwear across collections.

Womenswear · Menswear · Kidswear · Babywear · Accessories

- Do not open this section with “Knitted for women”. It can imply that womenswear is MBK’s primary or only category.
- All five categories should be immediately visible on desktop, each represented by a strong image and its category name. Basic product breadth should not depend on clicking arrows or discovering hidden carousel items.

- Use the alternative five-card concept as the starting direction, but refine spacing, image crops and typography so the five categories read as one coherent capability statement rather than five separate advertisements.

04 — How We Work preview

From development to production.

Five stages, one accountable partner.

Explore how we work →

Replace the long scroll-controlled process presentation on the homepage with a compact visual sequence. On desktop, show the five stages together in one horizontal composition. Each stage should include a number, a representative image, a title and one short supporting line. The detailed explanation remains on the How We Work page.

01

Review & Quotation

Project route, technical considerations and quotation aligned before development begins.

02

Development & Sampling

From technical specifications or early references to a product ready to assess and refine.

03

Approval & Planning

Approved product, quantities and delivery window aligned before production.

04

Production & Quality Control

Production follows approved specifications, with quality monitored across the process.

05

Delivery & Reorders

Final control and shipment, with established styles able to build on previous development.

- On mobile, stack the stages vertically in the same order. Do not require carousel arrows to understand the process.

05 — Studio preview

Where ideas take shape in knit.

Our in-house Studio brings together yarn, programming, construction and garment development, connecting creative direction with the realities of production.

Explore the Studio →

- Keep one strong, process-relevant image rather than a large editorial block. Hands, materials, programming or development work are more informative here than generic fashion imagery.
- The homepage should introduce the Studio as a differentiating capability; the detailed explanation belongs on the Studio page.

06 — Responsibility / certifications

Certified standards. Responsible manufacturing.

MBK is certified to GOTS, GRS, RWS and OCS, providing recognised frameworks for traceability and environmental and social requirements across certified production.

Explore responsibility →

- Keep the sheep/certification visual concept. It is memorable, relevant and creates a strong visual break in the homepage.
- Reduce the section height slightly through spacing and scale, but do not substantially redesign the composition.
- Replace the absolute headline “A fully certified supply chain that respects both people and the environment.” The standards do address traceability, environmental and social criteria, but certification depends on the selected materials, supply chain and documentation of each project. The proposed wording above is more precise and remains commercially strong.
- Keep the certification years and Ecocert identification/license information accurate and legible.

07 — From the Journal

From the Journal.

Technical knowledge, materials, responsible manufacturing and perspectives from inside MBK.

Explore all articles →

- The Journal is strategically useful and should remain on the homepage because it demonstrates knowledge and manufacturing authority.
- Show three selected article cards fully visible on desktop. The selection does not need to be final now because the Journal content library is still being populated.
- A horizontal scroll to the right may remain as secondary exploration so visitors can continue browsing additional articles. The important point is that the first three cards must already be complete and understandable without requiring interaction.
- Later, choose homepage articles editorially rather than automatically displaying only the three newest. A balanced mix of technical know-how, materials/responsibility and company news may communicate MBK better than chronological selection alone.

08 — Closing CTA and footer

Where your next knit begins.

Tell us what you're working on.

Start a Project →

Keep the dark background, photographic fade and “Where your next knit begins.” concept. This is one of the strongest visual endings in the site. It should not be replaced by a conventional small corporate footer. However, make the module more efficient:

- Reduce the total height so the closing area no longer feels like a full additional hero. As a design direction, aim for roughly two-thirds of the current visual height on desktop, while preserving the image/fade and headline impact.
- Reduce the headline scale modestly and tighten the vertical spacing between headline, CTA and contact details.
- Keep the “Start a Project” CTA here even though it is also in the header. This repetition is intentional: the header provides permanent access; the closing CTA appears after the visitor has absorbed the page and is the natural conversion point.
- Contact information should be compact: Email, Instagram and LinkedIn. Do not repeat the website URL while the visitor is already on the website.
- Do not publish the personal/mobile telephone number. If a telephone contact is considered necessary later, use the general commercial number.

- Add legal/privacy links in a discreet bottom bar. The same footer should be reused consistently across the site.

4. Typography, spacing and page rhythm

- Create a consistent typography system for H1, H2, section labels, body copy and CTAs. The script/serif contrast is a distinctive part of the concept and may remain, but the number of sizes and visual weights should be reduced.
- Small uppercase labels currently appear too pale in some sections. Increase contrast so they remain elegant but comfortably legible, including on smaller screens.
- Avoid oversized statements occupying an entire viewport unless the message justifies that level of emphasis.
- Use a consistent content grid and safe area beneath the sticky navigation. Text alignment may vary when there is a clear compositional reason, but it should not feel accidental.
- Do not use “must fit on one screen” as a universal rule. Instead, review proportions so each section feels complete, the transitions are intentional and scrolling remains fluid and easy.
- For the opening of each internal page, establish a repeatable hero template: navigation + page label + H1 + introductory copy should read as one complete composition. The next section should not appear as an accidental half-image or half-title at the bottom of the initial desktop viewport.

5. Start a Project form

“Start a Project” should lead to a simple B2B enquiry form. Please remove the current estimated-quantity selector until the options are aligned with MBK’s commercial qualification logic. We do not want to publish the MOQ through this form.

- Name
- Company / Brand
- Email
- Website (optional)
- Country
- What are you looking to develop or produce? — open field
- Target delivery / season — optional
- Upload tech pack / reference / project information — optional
- Send Enquiry →

6. Pre-launch technical / accessibility checks

Please verify the following before launch. These are technical implementation items and should be treated separately from the visual review:

- Privacy Policy available from the footer and a clear privacy/data-processing notice associated with the enquiry form.
- Canonical URL.
- Open Graph metadata for link sharing.
- Twitter/X card metadata where applicable.
- Organisation structured data.
- Favicon correctly declared.
- Skip link / keyboard-accessible navigation.
- Image dimensions declared and non-critical images lazy-loaded where appropriate.
- Large source images optimised for web delivery.
- prefers-reduced-motion alternative for the opening animation and any scroll-controlled motion.

- Mobile QA for oversized headings, sticky sections and any horizontal-scrolling components.

7. Priority for Version 4

CRITICAL

- Make MBK's B2B flat-knit development/manufacturing role explicit in the hero.
- Fix sticky-navigation collisions and opening-section composition across breakpoints.
- Use precise certification/responsibility wording.
- Add a concise company-value section immediately after the hero.

IMPORTANT

- Remove the full-screen statistics module.
- Show all five product categories without requiring carousel discovery.
- Replace the long homepage process with the compact five-stage visual sequence.
- Reduce Studio to a clear capability preview with link to the full page.
- Show three complete Journal cards; horizontal scroll may continue after them.
- Rationalise typography, spacing and vertical rhythm.
- Use Start a Project consistently as the primary commercial CTA.

MINOR

- Slightly reduce Responsibility and closing-footer height while preserving their visual concepts.

8. Final design principle

Preserve the agency's editorial/fashion sensibility, but place a much stronger B2B information architecture underneath it.

The goal is not to make the homepage denser for its own sake. It is to make it immediately clear what MBK is, why its manufacturing model matters and where a prospective fashion brand should go next — while retaining the distinctive visual language that makes the website feel relevant to the premium fashion industry.